ELKRIS BENEVOLENT FOUNDATION

MOBILIZATION CAMPAIGN FOR "DIABETES AWARENESS" AND "EARLY DETECTION"

Our Vision Statement – *More than 7 million adult Nigerians are living with Diabetes, and they are not aware. Another 15 million are prediabetic, unaware they are months or few years away from full blown diabetes. Our vision is to help **"Reach"** a minimum of 500,000 of the above 22 million population, every year!*

Our Mission Statement – *to deploy sensitization vehicles such as social media, radio, TV, and Community Outreaches to bring awareness on how blood sugar works,*

***b)** and also, to run FREE Basic Blood Sugar Screening Outreaches, through a total of 15 early detection centers across the 4 top urban cities, in Nigeria.*

THE GROWING MENACE OF "DIABETES" IN NIGERIA:

Available data tells us that the total diabetic population of Nigeria as at 2000 was a mere 209.4 thousand adults.

Just 25 years on, the rate of diabetes in Nigeria has developed into a national epidemic. In fact, there's now a growing call for the authorities to declare a state of emergency on the growing burden of excess blood sugar and diabetes in Nigeria.

As at 2026, the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare confirm that up to **8% of Nigeria's population** now live with diabetes. And according to the Diabetes Association of Nigeria (DAN), only 11.4 million of the approximately 19 million population have been officially diagnosed.
In other words, there are close to 7 million other persons who are living with diabetes in Nigeria and they are not even aware.

Nigeria's PreDiabetes Population:

Going by most recent figures, while the World Health Organization using their criteria put the Prediabetes population of Nigeria at 12.5 million, African Journals Online estimated that the diabetes population of our nation Nigeria is up to 15.8 million people.

Here's why the above figure should be very worrisome. In a country where there are no dedicated programmes towards early detection, the likelihood of more than 90 per cent of the 15million prediabetes population going on to develop full blown diabetes in the next few years is almost guaranteed.

Our Personal Survey:

Here at Elkris Benevolent Foundation, we carried out a Lagos city-wide FREE basic Blood Sugar screening two years ago. The outcome was startling. We screened an average of 100 persons per local community. And of the 5,000-plus adults (30 – 80ys) screened, as much as 3 in every 5 registered excess blood sugar. High blood pressure was a common factor associated with much of the 3 out of the 5 that tested positive for excess blood sugar.

Increasing Rate Of Clinical Complications Associated With Rising Burden Of Diabetes In Nigeria

Increasing Rate of Kidney Failure:

The rate of kidney diseases and eventually kidney failure in Nigeria is fast becoming alarming. And here's what is even more alarming. Diabetes has been identified as the leading cause of chronic kidney disease in Nigeria, and responsible for nearly 40% of all kidney failure cases.

Diabetic Foot Ulcers (DFU) & Amputations:

Amputations associated with foot ulcer is fast becoming a common place. Our survey found that the earliest most Nigerians get to know of the diabetes status is when they are already battling foot

ulcer or early symptoms of kidney failure. Foot ulcers occur frequently due to poor glycaemic control, peripheral neuropathy, and delayed care. Amputation rates among diabetes patients have been found to be 15 times higher than in non-diabetics.

Cardiovascular Diseases & Stroke:

Understandably, hypertension has been found to be present in over 60% of Nigerian diabetes patients. Hypertension on its own has been implicated in majority of lifestyle health challenges in Nigeria. A major contributor to overall death rate in Nigeria. But when combine with diabetes, the risk of heart attacks and strokes becomes multiplied.

Insulin Emergencies:

A good number of clinical coma incidents in hospitals across Nigeria recently have been traced to serious fluctuations in insulin levels. For most cases, before proper treatment could be administered, it is already too late. Acute metabolic crises now account for roughly 40% to 46% of tertiary hospital admissions related to diabetes.

Clinical Blindness:

The rise in clinical blindness in Nigeria is due to diabetes. It is primarily driven by diabetic retinopathy and its related complications. Chronic high blood sugar has been proven to help damage the small blood vessels in the retina. Diabetic retinopathy has been confirmed to threaten the vision of many Nigerian

WHAT ARE THE EARLY SYMPTOMS OF DIABETES?

Here are a number of early symptoms to watch out for when it comes to excess blood sugar and diabetes. Whereas, some of these symptoms may not be due to the onset of diabetes however; the only way to be sure is to undergo basic test.
Meanwhile, here are some of the primary symptoms associated with the unset of diabetes;

Frequent Urination:

While one or two other health scares may also show through frequent urination, it is advisable not to waste time going through necessary doctors' investigations. Frequent urination is a way the body tries to get rid of extra blood sugar through urine.

Excessive Thirst:

With excess blood sugar or diabetes, constant fluid loss from frequent urination will usually leave you feeling very thirsty.

Unexplained Weight Loss:

Sudden (unexplained) weight loss is another way blood sugar diseases express themselves. This is so because the body starts to burn fat and muscle for energy, instead of glucose,

Constant fatigue and weakness:

Cells do not get enough sugar for normal energy, leaving you tired even after resting.

Increased hunger:

Cells lack energy, triggering a continuous signal to eat.

Blurred vision:

High blood sugar levels can change the shape of the eye's lens temporarily.

Abuja Free Basic Blood Sugar Test Centers

- **Wuse Market**
- **Banex**
- **Gwagwalada Market**
- **Mararaba Market**

Lagos Free Basic Blood Sugar Test Centers

- **Marina Lagos**

- **Ikeja Mall**
- **Xxx**
- **Xxx**
- **Xxx**

Port Harcourt Free Basic Blood Sugar TestCenters

- **Xxx**
- **xxx**

Kano Free Basic Blood Sugar TestCenters

- **Xxx**